



YOU ARE **17 WEEKS EXACTLY**
161 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Every part of your baby has an enhanced blood supply bringing nutrients for growth. Blood vessels are easy to see on scans because the skin is still quite transparent, with little fat yet deposited beneath the skin.

“While your energy levels are at a peak, make the most of eating out but choose your meals wisely.”

It's possible to eat out safely. However, you may have to ask what's in particular dishes to avoid eating foods that aren't recommended during pregnancy (see [Dietary precautions](#)).

Request that your meat and poultry are cooked to well done. You can check this by inserting a sharp knife—if the juices are still pink, ask for it to be recooked. Ask if the dairy products, particularly cheeses you aren't familiar with, are made with pasteurized milk.

If fried or fatty foods upset your stomach and cause heartburn, stick with foods that have been oven baked or steamed, and avoid fatty cuts of meat.

A lot of sushi contains shellfish, but you should only eat cooked shellfish during pregnancy. Raw shellfish contains harmful viruses and bacteria. If you're served sushi, ask whether the shellfish has been cooked and whether any other fish used has been frozen first. If it has, it should be safe to eat.

STRONGER NAILS

Your nails are likely to be stronger and healthier than ever, due to the hormonal changes that occur during pregnancy.

Since your nails are in good condition, you can simply file them and they'll look nice even without nail polish. If you do decide to have a manicure, make sure it takes place in a well-ventilated room. Avoid using nail polishes that contain dibutyl phthalate (DBP), an ingredient that is linked to birth defects in animals.

ASK A NUTRITIONIST

I'm a vegetarian but keep craving meat. Is this normal? Yes, when you're pregnant, it is common for your body to crave certain foods. One theory is that, even as a vegetarian, you may crave meat because you are not getting sufficient iron from your diet.